Cover-letter draft for author review
Candidate journal: *Bioinformatics*; candidate article type: Original Paper.
Not sent. Submission is currently NO_GO.

Dear Editors,

We have prepared the review manuscript "Reconstruction gains without superiority over an autoregressive comparator: a bounded antimicrobial peptide evaluation." It examines a retrieved AMP implementation using fixed computational development experiments. A categorical objective improves both reconstruction and low-order generation distances relative to a same-capacity squared-error pipeline. Nevertheless, the executed autoregressive comparator has lower values on those generation distances. These distinct comparisons are reported without asserting a reversal of reconstruction and generation rankings. The manuscript preserves unsuccessful follow-up experiments and distinguishes historical peptide records from validation of the newly trained models.

The intended contribution is a limited implementation-level evaluation. We do not claim a new model, a first demonstration that reconstruction differs from generation, a representative benchmark, or a biologically validated design application. Recent comparative AMP generation work and QMAP are discussed as close precedents. The experiments use one fitted seed and a repeatedly accessed development set; baseline optimization adequacy remains unresolved. These limitations currently prevent a submission-readiness claim.

The manuscript and supplementary information disclose substantive use of OpenAI Codex assistants for code development, execution support, analysis, literature checks, scientific drafting and technical review. Separate AI agents performed checks; these are not human peer review. Human authors must verify the scientific content, references, all AI-assisted work and the final disclosures. Exact historical model versions and the complete prior AI-use history still require confirmation.

Before this letter could accompany a submission, the human authors must confirm author order and affiliations, contributions, funding and competing interests, the relationship of resources to AMPGen and other work, data/code release arrangements, and the scientific scope. Originality, exclusive submission and approval by all authors have not been verified and are intentionally not asserted. Historical MIC records retain undefined outcomes and unresolved provenance rather than being presented as new-model validation.

The current package is provided for substantive author and independent review. This letter does not request editorial action and has not been transmitted to the journal.

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`yangjie08@hdu.edu.cn` — identity and authorization to be confirmed.